

WEEK 2 OF 4 · Body

Script 2: Finding Your True Center**Theme: Balance and Alignment**

Rationale: Mindfulness involves noticing when we "overextend" and leave ourselves "off center." This exercise focuses on physical alignment and weight distribution to prevent being off-balance.

Request that students find their meditation stance — knees, cross-legged, or horse stance. Remind students of the "out."

"For our second Body exercise, we are going to focus on our Center. In the martial arts, if we are physically off-balance, we cannot generate power, and we are easily knocked down.

Take a moment to settle into your stance. Close your eyes or lower your gaze. I want you to imagine a plumb line dropping from the top of your head, down through your spine, and into the ground.

Very gently, lean your body slightly forward. Notice how your muscles have to tighten to keep you from falling. Now, lean slightly back. Notice the tension in your core and back. Lean slightly to the left... and to the right.

Now, make those movements smaller and smaller until you find the perfect middle. This is your 'True Center.' Notice how, in this spot, your body doesn't have to fight gravity. Your bones hold you up, not just your muscles. You are aligned. You are efficient.

Take three breaths here, memorizing what this stability feels like. (Pause for 15 seconds.)

If you feel yourself drifting, gently sway back to the center. When you are ready, open your eyes."